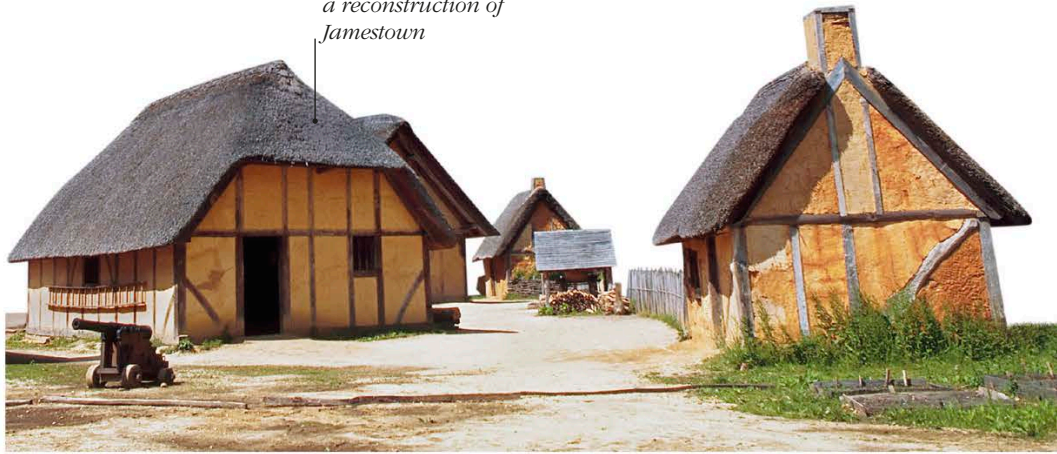


▼ EARLY INTERACTIONS

The Indigenous peoples of North America had advanced civilizations. They had mastered farming and traded furs, animal skins, and precious stones. Despite conflicts with the European colonizers, some Indigenous peoples traded with the newcomers and taught them how to farm and survive.



Thatched cottage in a reconstruction of Jamestown



▲ THE THIRTEEN COLONIES

Jamestown in modern-day Virginia was the first permanent English colony in North America, established in 1607. The English had established 12 more colonies along the coast by 1733, and these settlements gradually extended inland. The Thirteen Colonies, as they came to be known, developed into strong trading and agricultural communities, and even established their own laws.



◀ EUROPEAN CONFLICTS

In the first half of the 18th century, North America became a battleground for European powers as colonists from France, Britain, and Spain fought to seize each other's lands, often supported by rival native peoples (left). By 1763, after the French had suffered a succession of major losses, Britain came to control almost all of North America.



▲ ROAD TO REVOLUTION

After the costly battles against the French, the British government forced their North American colonies to pay heavy new taxes. Matters came to a head in 1773 when colonists in Boston threw chests of tea into the harbor (above) to protest a tea tax. The government's attempts to punish those responsible resulted in a popular rebellion against Britain, leading to the American Revolution (see pp.150–151).